

Postdoctoral Award: how to apply

Find out how to apply for a Postdoctoral Award. Here you will also discover how to get help with your application, how we will assess your application, and what to expect at each stage of the application process.

How to apply for a Postdoctoral Award

Applying for a Postdoctoral Award is a single-stage process. Please visit the funding opportunity page you are applying to for key dates.

Apply through an open opportunity. From there you will be taken to our online awards management system where you can complete your application.

[View all Postdoctoral Award funding opportunities \(https://www.nihr.ac.uk/funding-opportunities?career_development%5BPostdoctoral+Award%5D=Postdoctoral+Award\)](https://www.nihr.ac.uk/funding-opportunities?career_development%5BPostdoctoral+Award%5D=Postdoctoral+Award)

Postdoctoral Award

Postdoctoral Award (Cohort 3)

Postdoctoral Award

Salaried time to undertake funded postdoctoral research and a bespoke training and development programme.

Opening date:

23 April 2026 at 1:00 pm

Closing date:

16 June 2026 at 1:00 pm

Status:

Postdoctoral Award

Postdoctoral Award [Cohort 2]

This award is for anyone with a PhD or a submitted PhD thesis under assessment who has not yet been appointed to a professorial post.

Opening date:

21 October 2025 at 1:00 pm

Closing date:

16 December 2025 at 1:00 pm

Status:

Application resources

These resources will help you prepare and submit your application to one of our funding opportunities.

Application form guidance

Use our Postdoctoral Award guidance to help you complete your funding application in our awards management system. It explains what you need to include in each part of the form, to help you submit the best application possible.

[Postdoctoral Award application guidance \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/how-to-apply/application-guidance\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/how-to-apply/application-guidance)

(/support-and-services/research-support-service)

Research Support Service

The Research Support Service helps researchers at any stage of their career to develop competitive funding applications for health, public health and social care research.

(/research-funding/application-support/designing-your-research)

Designing your research

Find out where to get help in designing your research study and other important considerations.

Our commitment to inclusion

We are committed to [creating a diverse and inclusive culture \(/about-us/who-we-are/research-inclusion\)](/about-us/who-we-are/research-inclusion). We encourage applications from people from all backgrounds and communities bringing diverse skills and experiences.

Additional support

We are committed to removing barriers to inclusion wherever possible. We want to maximise the inclusion of disabled people and individuals with long term health conditions. We want to make sure our processes are as inclusive as possible and this might mean we need to make adjustments to the application process or for the undertaking of the award if successful.

If you need to discuss a reasonable adjustment to support completion of the application, please contact personal.awards@nihr.ac.uk (mailto:personal.awards@nihr.ac.uk)

You should not disclose detailed information of reasonable adjustments required to undertake the award in your application. Costings for reasonable adjustment that you, or any co-applicants may require, however should be included within your budget. See our [finance guidance \(/research-funding/application-support/guidance/finance-guidance-for-applicants\)](/research-funding/application-support/guidance/finance-guidance-for-applicants) for more information. We will discuss this with you further if your application is successful.

Additional resources

Access more resources to support your application:

[choosing your contracting organisation \(/career-development/nihr-academy/apply-nihr-career-development-awards/choosing-contracting-organisation-career-development-awards\)](/career-development/nihr-academy/apply-nihr-career-development-awards/choosing-contracting-organisation-career-development-awards)

[choosing your contracting organisation as a clinical or practitioner academic \(/career-development/nihr-academy/apply-career-development-awards/contracting-organisation/clinical-practitioner-academic\)](#)

[personal career development award durations \(/personal-career-development-award-durations\)](#)

[applied research collaborations \(/about-us/what-we-do/infrastructure/applied-research-collaborations\)](#)

[FutureNHS](#)

[\(https://future.nhs.uk/system/login?nextURL=%2Fconnect%2Eti%2FLocalAuthorityHealthCareRes](https://future.nhs.uk/system/login?nextURL=%2Fconnect%2Eti%2FLocalAuthorityHealthCareRes)

[The James Lind alliance \(http://www.jla.nihr.ac.uk/\)](http://www.jla.nihr.ac.uk/)

[UK Data Service \(https://ukdataservice.ac.uk/\)](https://ukdataservice.ac.uk/)

[School for Public Health Research \(https://sphr.nihr.ac.uk/\)](https://sphr.nihr.ac.uk/)

[School for Primary care research \(https://www.spcr.nihr.ac.uk/\)](https://www.spcr.nihr.ac.uk/)

[School for Social Care Research \(https://www.sscr.nihr.ac.uk/\)](https://www.sscr.nihr.ac.uk/)

Assessment criteria

The funding committee for the Postdoctoral Award will assess your application based on these assessment criteria:

[Postdoctoral Award assessment criteria \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/assessment-criteria\)](#)

Decision timeline

The funding decision will follow this process:

Funding opportunity closes

Submit your application by the closing date

Funding committee assesses applications

Our funding committee will review your application and decide whether it will be shortlisted

External peer review

Your application will undergo peer review

Final funding decision

We will let you know whether your application has been successful for funding

Interviews

If your application is shortlisted you will be invited to interview before the committee makes a final funding decision.

Find out more about our funding committees and funding committee members:

[Postdoctoral Award committees \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/committees\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/committees)

More information and contact

[Postdoctoral Award: funding committees \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/predocutorial/predocutorial-award/committees\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/predocutorial/predocutorial-award/committees)

[Postdoctoral Award: eligibility and what you can apply for \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/eligibility-what-you-can-apply-for\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/eligibility-what-you-can-apply-for)

[Postdoctoral Award: overview \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award)

Contact us

Contact us if you have questions about the programme. Raise issues about completing a funding application online through our awards management system.

Telephone:

[0113 532 8444](tel:01135328444) (tel:01135328444)

Email:

personal.awards+poda@nihr.ac.uk (mailto:personal.awards+poda@nihr.ac.uk)